Does AI know your business exists?

A practical guide to being found, understood and recommended in the age of AI search

SEO AEO GEO

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ABOUT THIS GUIDE

What's inside

This guide shows you how to check whether AI can find, understand and recommend your business, and what to do about it. Each section ends with something you can do this week, and the checklist on page 8 gives you a simple way to track your progress.

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SECTION 1

Why this matters

People are already turning to AI for recommendations. They ask it to help plan a holiday, decide what to buy or choose a service. More and more, they also ask it to recommend a business.

ChatGPT | Claude | Gemini | Perplexity | Copilot

When customers ask AI for a business like yours, does yours come up?

SECTION 1 · A SIMPLE EXAMPLE

Sarah's story

Sarah is an imaginary customer. She's in her 50s and self-employed. She has pensions from three previous jobs. As retirement approaches, she is unsure whether her pension savings are on track.

IN THE PAST: SEARCH

"Financial adviser in London"

A page of links. She browses the websites, reads reviews and compares her options.

TODAY: SHE ASKS AI

"I'm in my 50s, self-employed, with several pensions. Can you recommend a financial adviser in London who specialises in retirement planning?"

Why the location matters: customers looking for a local business often add a place, such as London, Pinner or Harrow, to narrow down the results. If you serve local customers, make sure your location is clear everywhere online.

Now imagine you're that adviser

You'd be a good fit for Sarah. But this is what AI finds:

YOUR WEBSITE

"Helping you achieve your financial goals."

LINKEDIN

"Wealth management adviser."

OLD DIRECTORIES

Services you no longer offer.

Your website doesn't say that you specialise in retirement planning for self-employed people, or that you support clients as they approach retirement. So AI has very little to go on, and it might recommend somebody else.

The same problem can affect any business, for example an accountant, an HR consultant or an IT support company.

THE ONE QUESTION TO TAKE AWAY

What question do you want your business to be the answer to?

SECTION 2

Find. Answer. Recommend.

Three simple things to remember: find me, answer me, recommend me. That's SEO, AEO and GEO.

Find me.

SEO · Search engine optimisation

Can Google find your website and understand what you offer?

"Financial adviser London"

Answer me.

AEO · Answer engine optimisation

Does your content clearly answer the questions your customers are asking?

"What should I look for in a retirement adviser?"

Recommend me.

GEO · Generative engine optimisation

Can your business appear in an AI-generated answer or recommendation?

"Recommend a retirement adviser in London for someone in their 50s"

The good news: you don't need three different strategies. They work together.

- When your website **clearly explains what you do**, it helps Google understand your business. It also helps AI understand what you offer.
- When you **answer questions your customers often ask**, you make your content more useful to both Google and AI.
- When you have **genuine customer reviews and mentions** on other websites, you build credibility.

So the same improvements can help your business across all three.



Does SEO still matter?

Absolutely. People still use Google to search for businesses, and SEO remains important.

But the way people search is changing. They're also asking AI for answers and recommendations. So it's no longer just about being found on Google. It's also about making sure AI can understand your business and what you offer.

The basics still count: a website that loads quickly, is easy to navigate and shows reviews and clear contact details.

Quick check: if your website blocks AI search crawlers, your content is harder to use in AI answers. Ask your web developer to check your robots.txt file.

SECTION 3

Five practical checks

Where should you focus? These five checks make your business information clearer and more credible, to people and to AI.

1 **Clarity**

Is it clear what you do, who you help and when you're relevant?

Try this: be specific. For example, "Retirement planning for self-employed people" is much clearer than "Helping you achieve your financial goals".

2 **Consistency**

Do your website, LinkedIn, Google Business Profile, social media and directory listings tell the same story?

Try this: search for your business name and update or remove old listings.

3 **Useful content**

Are you answering the questions your customers actually ask? This could be through FAQs, articles or your service pages.

Try this: turn the questions you hear every week into FAQs or short articles. One detailed, genuinely useful answer is worth more than several brief, generic posts.

4 **Proof**

What shows your expertise? Think customer reviews, qualifications and case studies.

Try this: add a short case study or a few recent reviews to your website and LinkedIn.

5 **Corroboration**

That's simply other people or businesses backing up what you say.

Try this: look for mentions in professional directories, industry associations, event websites, podcasts or articles.

When other businesses mention you or recommend your services, it helps build your credibility.

That's one of the reasons networking is so valuable.

SECTION 3 · A USEFUL FRAMEWORK

Foundation, signals, authority

A simple way to decide what to work on first: get the basics right, then show proof, then let others confirm it.

Foundation

Make sure AI understands who you are.

What you do · who you help · what you're known for · consistent information · a website that can be crawled

Checks 1 and 2: clarity and consistency

Signals

Create evidence for that identity.

Useful content · FAQs · reviews · credentials · case studies · structured information

Checks 3 and 4: useful content and proof

Authority

Widen the independent confirmation.

Associations · directories · articles · podcasts · events · speaking · client evidence

Check 5: corroboration

Example: the financial adviser from Sarah's story

Foundation **Get the basics right**	Use the same description everywhere: "Retirement planning for self-employed people" on the website, LinkedIn, Google Business Profile and every directory listing.
Signals **Show proof**	Add an FAQ that answers "I'm self-employed with several pensions. Where do I start?", plus client reviews and a short case study.
Authority **Let others confirm it**	Get listed in a professional directory, quoted in a local business article, and recommended by people you meet at networking events.

SECTION 4

Your action plan: three steps

Here are three things you can do this week.

1

Check your profiles

Look at your website, LinkedIn and Google Business Profile. Do they clearly describe what you do and who you help? Are your details up to date?

2

Answer one customer question

Pick a question your customers often ask. Write a clear, helpful answer and put it on your website, as an FAQ or a short blog post.

3 **Try the AI test**

ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini · Perplexity

Ask ChatGPT, or your favourite AI chatbot, to search online for a business like yours. Include what your customer needs and your location. Don't give it your business name.

DON'T ASK

"Tell me about my company."

That only tests your name.

DO ASK: FILL IN THE BLANKS

"Can you recommend **[your service]** in **[your area]** who helps **[your ideal customer]** with **[their need]**?"

FOR EXAMPLE

"Can you recommend an HR consultant in Harrow who helps small businesses hire their first employee?"

Then check three things

- **Does your business appear?**
- **Are the details accurate?**
- **Which sources does AI cite?**

Open those sources and check them. AI can make mistakes, and the answers can vary, so try a few versions of the question and a few different AI tools.

Don't worry if you appear in one AI tool but not another. Each tool answers differently, and no one can guarantee a recommendation. What you can control is making sure your information is correct, consistent and easy to find everywhere.

Not there yet? That's your starting point.

Look at the businesses AI does mention. What do they explain clearly that you don't?

SECTION 5 · YOUR STARTING POINT

Your AI visibility checklist

Print this page and tick what's already true. The gaps show you what to work on next.

- [ ] **I'm clear on who I help and what I do**
  In the words my customers would use.
- [ ] **My details match everywhere**
  Website, Google Business Profile, LinkedIn, social media profiles (like Facebook or Instagram) and directories.
- [ ] **Old listings and unused profiles are updated or removed**
  No outdated services or contact details, and no abandoned social media accounts.
- [ ] **My pages answer real customer questions**
  Including local ones, like "best accountant in Pinner".
- [ ] **My expertise is easy to verify**
  Reviews, qualifications, case studies, published work.
- [ ] **Other websites mention my work**
  Directories, associations, events, articles, partners.
- [ ] **My website lets AI search crawlers in**
  Checked with my web developer.
- [ ] **I've run the AI test**
  In ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Perplexity, and I repeat it once a month.
- [ ] **I ask new clients how they found me**
  Including whether they used AI.

You can't control whether AI recommends you. But you are in control of the information you share. Make it clear, useful and easy to check.

SECTION 6

Free tools and next steps

Answer The Public

Finds the questions people ask about your topic. A few free searches a day.

Perplexity

Shows how AI answers questions in your field, and which sources it uses.

ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini

Run your AI visibility test once a month.

Google Analytics

Spot visits coming from AI tools like ChatGPT.

Keep it going

- Answer local questions, like “Who’s the best accountant in Pinner?”
- Put FAQs where they help: on each service page, plus one general FAQ page.
- Publish regularly: at least one genuinely useful article a month.
- Use LinkedIn. AI tools can read it too, so share your expertise there.

WANT HELP?

Free AI readiness assessment

Five minutes, with an instant scorecard.

www.integroai.tech/assessment

Free 30-minute discovery call

A no-obligation chat about your AI visibility.

calendly.com/integroai-tech/30min

Does AI know you exist?

And if it does, does it know what you can help customers with?